

AMERILIFE

ideaXchange

Content Team Guide

How to create, organize, and publish gated ideaXchange content in WordPress. Internal use only — for editors and content managers.

WordPress admin: headlessameril.wpenginepowered.com/wp-admin

Published experience: amerilife.com/ideaxchange (login required)

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1. What is ideaXchange?

ideaXchange is AmeriLife’s private member area on amerilife.com. Content is authored in **WordPress** and displayed on the gated site after users sign in with their AmeriLife Microsoft account.

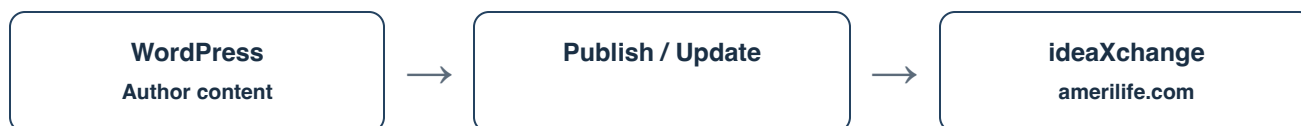
As a content editor, you work entirely in **WordPress Admin**. You do not need to touch code or the public website theme. When you publish or update a post in WordPress, the live ideaXchange experience updates automatically.

Important: ideaXchange content is separate from the public *Insights* magazine (/insights/). Use the **ideaXchange** menus described in this guide — not the public Insights post type.

2. WordPress modules at a glance

In the left sidebar of WordPress Admin, you will see these ideaXchange menus:

WordPress menu	What you create	Where it appears on ideaXchange
ideaXchange Articles	News stories, updates, thought leadership	Home feed, pillar sidebars, and article pages — depending on Tags
ideaXchange Case Studies	Recruiting campaigns with downloadable assets	Recruiting Hub — campaigns table, hero, and detail pages
ideaXchange Companies	Affiliate / agency company profiles	Recruiting Hub — company profile pages; linked from case studies
ideaXchange Carriers	Carrier partner profiles, highlights, downloads	Career Spotlight — carrier grid and profile pages
ideaXchange Leaderboard	Seven fixed sales ranking tables (file upload)	Sales Leaderboard — brokerage audience only



3. Site sections & who can see them

ideaXchange is organized into **pillars** (main sections). Which pillars a member can open depends on their **login group** (Brokerage or Career). This is controlled by IT / Entra — *not* by a field in WordPress.

ideaXchange section	Brokerage users	Career users
Home (main feed)	✓	✓
Recruiting Hub	✓	✓
Sales Leaderboard	✓	—
Career Leaderboard	—	✓
Career Spotlight (carriers)	✓	✓
Sales Success (incentives & stories)	✓	✓

Two layers of “visibility”:

- ① **Section access** — which pillars appear in the nav (Brokerage vs Career login).
- ② **Item visibility** — set on each post in WordPress (see Section 4). Both must align for a user to see a specific piece of content.

4. Audience visibility (per item)

Almost every ideaXchange content type has an **Audience visibility** box in the WordPress editor (right sidebar). Use it to control which logged-in groups can see *that specific item*.

Setting in WordPress	Who can see this item
Brokerage	Brokerage (sales / distribution) users only
Career	Career (recruiting) users only
Brokerage+Career	Everyone with ideaXchange access (<i>default</i>)

Applies to: **Articles**, **Case Studies**, **Companies**, **Carriers**, and **Leaderboard tables**.

How to set visibility

- 1 Open the post in WordPress (Edit Article, Edit Case Study, etc.).
- 2 Find the **Audience visibility** panel on the right.
- 3 Choose **Brokerage**, **Career**, or **Brokerage+Career**.
- 4 Click **Update** or **Publish**.

The post list table also shows a **Visibility** column so you can audit content at a glance.



5. Articles — fields, tags & placement

ideaXchange Articles are the primary story format. They power the Home feed and appear in multiple pillars based on how you tag them.

Standard WordPress fields

- **Title** — headline on cards and article page
- **Content** — full article body
- **Excerpt** — short summary on listing cards (recommended)
- **Featured image** — thumbnail on feeds and hero layouts
- **Slug** — URL-friendly name (auto-generated from title; edit if needed)

Topics (category-style)

Assign one **ideaXchange Topic** for the content theme. Default topics:

- Health
- Wealth
- Leadership
- Life

Topics appear as badges on article cards and in breadcrumbs.

Tags — controls which pillar section uses the article

Assign the correct **ideaXchange Tag** so the article surfaces in the right area:

Tag to assign	Where the article appears
Sales	Sales Leaderboard — newsroom / sidebar articles (brokerage users)
Recruit	Recruiting Hub — articles column and related recruiting content
Initiative	Sales Success — incentives, contests, and success stories
Featured	Marks the article for Featured rows on feeds (see below)

Rule of thumb: If an article should live in Recruiting Hub, add the `Recruit` tag. For Sales Success content, add `Initiative` . For Sales Leaderboard sidebars, add `Sales` . Articles with no pillar tag still appear on the **Home** feed for users who pass visibility rules.

Featured & Spotlight placement

Control prominence on listing pages:

- **Featured** — check *Featured* in Custom Fields **or** assign the `Featured` tag. Puts the article in the “Featured articles” row on Home and similar grids.
- **Spotlight** — enable the *Spotlight* custom field (`is_spotlight`). Highlights the article in the sidebar “Spotlight” slot on feed-style pages.

Tip: In the block editor, open **Preferences** → **Panels** and enable **Custom fields** if you do not see Spotlight / Featured checkboxes.

Article workflow (step by step)

- 1 **ideaXchange Articles** → **Add New**
- 2 Enter title, excerpt, body, and featured image.
- 3 Pick a **Topic** and the correct **Tag** (Sales / Recruit / Initiative).
- 4 Set **Audience visibility** (Brokerage, Career, or both).
- 5 Optionally mark **Featured** or **Spotlight**.
- 6 **Publish**. Article appears on Home and tagged pillar sections.

6. Case Studies & Companies (Recruiting Hub)

Companies

Create the affiliate profile **before** linking case studies.

- Title & description
- Featured image (logo)
- **Website URL** and optional Learn more URL
- **Audience visibility**

Case Studies

Each case study is a recruiting campaign on the Recruiting Hub.

- Title, excerpt, body, image
- **Company** dropdown (byline & link)
- Campaign table fields
- Download files for “Run this campaign”

Case study — key meta boxes

Field	Purpose
Company	Links to the company profile; shown as author on the case study and in the campaigns table
Spotlight sidebar	Feature this campaign in the Recruiting Hub sidebar
Featured on Recruiting Hub	Surfaces in the hero / featured area on Recruiting Hub
Get started button URL	CTA in “Run this campaign” sidebar (defaults to /connect/ if empty)
Target audience / Spend / Results	Columns in the Recruiting Hub Campaigns table
Overview tooltip	Optional info icon text in the campaigns table
Run this campaign — downloads	Call Scripts, Interview Questions, Email Templates, etc. (use <i>Choose file / Media Library</i>)
Audience visibility	Which login group sees this campaign

Recruiting Hub content flow



7. Carriers (Career Spotlight)

ideaXchange Carriers power the **Career Spotlight** section (carrier partner profiles). Visible to both Brokerage and Career users.

Carrier profile fields

- **Title**, excerpt, body, featured image (logo)
- **Brand color** — hex code for accent styling (e.g. `#244260`)
- **Website URL**
- **Hero tile** — large tile in the top row of the carrier grid
- **Featured in additional grid** — secondary featured placement
- **Highlights** — repeater with icon + short label (e.g. competitive rates, technology)
- **Carrier resources** — downloadable PDFs (Product Portfolio, Rate Sheets, Agent Resources, etc.)
- **Audience visibility**

Use **Choose file** in the Media Library for each resource — do not paste attachment IDs manually.

8. Sales Leaderboard tables

The **ideaXchange Leaderboard** menu contains exactly **seven pre-defined tables**. You cannot add or delete tables — only update their data.

How to update rankings

- 1 Go to **ideaXchange Leaderboard** → **Leaderboard tables (7)**.
- 2 Click the table you need to update (e.g. Health YTD, Wealth YTD).
- 3 Under **Upload table data**, choose an **.xlsx** file (recommended), .csv, or .json.
- 4 Set the **Report date**.
- 5 Click **Update**. The upload replaces all rows for that table.

Required columns: affiliate, ytd, lytd, vs_lytd, vs_lqtd, vs_lmtd, trend

Excel (.xlsx) is preferred because it preserves ▲ / ▼ trend symbols better than CSV.

9. Publishing checklist

Before publishing any ideaXchange item, confirm:

- ☐ Correct content type (Article, Case Study, Company, Carrier, or Leaderboard table)
- ☐ Title, excerpt, and featured image are complete
- ☐ For articles: correct **Topic** and **Tag** (Sales / Recruit / Initiative)
- ☐ **Audience visibility** matches the intended audience (Brokerage / Career / both)
- ☐ Case studies: **Company** linked and campaign downloads attached
- ☐ Carriers: highlights and resource files uploaded
- ☐ Leaderboard: data file uploaded and report date set
- ☐ Status is **Published** (not Draft)

10. Quick reference

I want to...	WordPress menu	Key settings
Publish a story on the Home feed	ideaXchange Articles	Topic + Visibility; optional Featured / Spotlight
Show an article on Recruiting Hub	ideaXchange Articles	Tag: Recruit
Show an article on Sales Success	ideaXchange Articles	Tag: Initiative
Show an article on Sales Leaderboard	ideaXchange Articles	Tag: Sales
Add a recruiting campaign	Case Studies (+ Companies)	Company link, table fields, downloads, Visibility
Add a carrier partner page	ideaXchange Carriers	Brand color, highlights, resources, Visibility
Update sales rankings	ideaXchange Leaderboard	Upload .xlsx to the correct table
Hide content from Career users	Any ideaXchange type	Audience visibility → Brokerage
Hide content from Brokerage users	Any ideaXchange type	Audience visibility → Career

Need help? Contact the AmeriLife digital / web team for WordPress access issues, missing menus, or questions about which tag or visibility setting to use.

